

ActInf GuestStream #035.1 ~ Jordan Hall & Matthew Pirkowski

GuestStream | Jordan Hall & Matthew Pirkowski | 1:56:14

foreign

hello and welcome this is active

inference guest stream number 35.1 it's
January 24th 2023.

today we're here with Jordan Hall and
Matthew burkowski we're going to have a
very interesting discussion so thank you

both for joining we will begin with a

Hello introduction from Jordan Matthew

will then set some context that will

launch us into a dialogue that will take

us on through so thanks again and Jordan

please

um since I lied in the Preamble so a

little bit of introduction I'm noticing

and this is I think part of the real

interest of having a conversation with

Matthew

um

uh is something like it would be nice I

think and plausible for us to actually

produce something new and useful in this

90-minute time span and I expect that

we'll want to be using something like a

a transparadigmatic method so we should

be grabbing Concepts from a variety of

different uh disciplines and frames and

applying them in the area of inquiry and

endeavoring to use that to actually

identify something that is specific and

perhaps hasn't been as articulated or

deeply investigated at least to my

awareness of course

um before and so the end result

hopefully will actually be worth worth

actually having been done and to have
been participated in
that's probably I I mean I I hope that
at least this recording in and of itself
as an artifact will be something useful
for a number of people who uh who might
have been paying attention to the
initial context and that we can bring
together as we typically do uh the many
types of frames that we've been
exploring uh in between our
conversations that are that are quite uh
quite fertile and oftentimes barefooter
in conversation so I'm always I always
look forward to our conversation
specifically for that reason

um

why we are here this morning or I guess
what did catalyze this initially was a
tweet that kind of randomly sent out the
other day as I had a network of Concepts
floating around in my head around uh
emergence governance the Tendencies uh
toward which that pattern flows and
so the Tweet may be the best to just
read it

um so

because that all forms of governance
Trend toward parasitic corruption should
be the first quote-unquote law of
political quote-unquote science the only
questions are how long before this
becomes unsustainable does it also
generate valuable byproducts and will it
will it fail catastrophically or
adaptively and so you know just the
general frame for the conversation is
something along the lines of

as we move through the world together
and attempt to identify points of
tension uh in terms of the relationship
between our communities and the
embedding context in which they exist
and attempt to navigate the world such
that they can retain their ability to to
function to cohere

um to generate new solutions that help
them mediate the tensions in the world
that are constantly attempting to or
constantly acting as a force against
those structures as we come together to
try to to to

um to network ourselves such that we can
function adaptively right to create
systems for doing so and that's evolved
you know quite a bit over time from uh
informal systems at the tribal level at
smaller social scales uh with respect to
uh structures that had much greater
coherence just as a function of the fact
that everyone knew each other everyone
was around one another uh in a daily
context uh had a deep history in terms
of their relational contextual knowledge
of uh those interpersonal relations
these lineages and so you didn't need a
great deal of abstraction in the
quote-unquote political domain you
didn't need to conceptualize an abstract
structure and then attempt to convince
people that this was the legitimate
structure to buy into as a stewardship
mechanism for themselves but as we
scaled up you know we started to
introduce these sorts of abstractions
um and and we are certainly in a time

now where you know it's worth asking
this question is as we create
abstractions that are uh into which we
pour our political energies you know for
example the idea of democratic
governance or you know the the sort of
Republic that uh we live in in the
United States

um

to what extent is their tendency uh of
those who are given stewardship over
that given their placement given their
necessity necessary placement within
this mechanism but also uh animate stuff
they have a mechanism but also just the
structure of that mechanism uh being
responsible as a small subset of the
population for stewarding its large
abstraction uh and this large degree of
attention and this large degree of
responsibility uh is it possible for
that to be resistant to corruption
across long periods of time is it
inevitable that uh that corruption will
exist and this was the claim in the
Tweet uh that people will fundamentally
begin to make choices that uh that that
direct all of that attention energy
toward their own ends as opposed to the
ends ostensible ends of the collective
um and then if that is a given

um

what frames can we hold despite the fact
that this is a given that can still act
as evaluative criteria and so a useful
evaluated criteria which is what sort of
those three ideas
um that I provided related to in terms

of the degree to which that can be an
unsustainable or a sustainable structure
um to the extent that it still generates
valuable byproducts even though that
that corruption is necessary or
inherently emergent within it or
um whether it will fail catastrophically
or adaptively will it essentially uh
will it undermine itself entirely or
will it actually within itself despite
that corruption uh be able to surface
new patterns into which itself can fail
uh as a kind of Lifeboat that
increasingly expands its own capacity so
that was you know I'll kind of step away
now and just give time for a reflection
and
um analysis on y'all's part
um but that was just sort of the initial
frame that I think catalyzed some
conversation here
all right well there's a there's a whole
bunch of different things that um are I
think implicated and I noticed that
I want to just kind of put a put a
variety of different uh plates on the
table without having to
um
understand exactly what meal we're
eating just yet so
in no particular order one thing that
comes up is
I feel like there's a there's an
invocation of a frame that I've used a
lot and that is something along the
lines of like major eras or apocs in the
Arc of evolution specifically in the
context of humans and so the first era

um wide which I which I refer to often
as unconscious Evolution or ordinary
Evolution what is the is the period I
think you were referring to be something
like lineage where there's the The
Binding constraints the various kinds of
characteristics of uh behavior that
steer the collective Choice making of a
group of

um
sort of indigenous humans uh was largely
a consequence of a very long
time and iterations under the ordinary
constraints of what I'll just call
ordinary biological evolution so lots of
trial and error and conservation of
relatively fit behaviors very tightly
knit and with all the various advantages
that are associated with that
um modality of exploring possibility
space

the second year of the second apoc
would be conscious design and I think
this is the domain where we see most of
the problematics and I'll invoke people
like tainter and [___] as other
individuals who've pointed to the
problematics that seem to be intrinsic
to the apoc or the modality of conscious
design and of course one of the sort of
most fundamental challenges is that it
exits us from the equilibrium or the
homeostatic feedback loops that are
characteristic of unconscious Evolution
so humans are able to operate in the
mode of conscious design we begin to
create novelty in the environment that
produces asymmetry in relationship with

all the other feedback loops that we happen to have been embedded in contextually but we don't actually fully understand the consequences of the asymmetries that we're producing and this creates a whole series of cascade effect so change explores that in the context of how a designed social infrastructure produces an arc that has a built-in closure because as we sort of play out the entropy that was built into the Inception of that social infrastructure which may take Generations or even many many generations we find ourselves collapsing back into the complex domain of the unconscious evolutionary basis and then we have a reset I think [__] more or less explores the same basic Dynamic within the particular domain of Science and I think they're they're largely if you look at them as being examples of a more generalized problematic you can then or or even Dynamic you can then use that to create a meta Theory

um

similarly I'm not sure exactly who studied this most carefully perhaps Hayek looking at it in the context of businesses which have a very similar and very well studied Dynamic the the s-curve of a business structure where an entrepreneurial um group usually one or two or five Founders like a very small group operating in many ways principally from the unconscious evolutionary stage like operating in very much a human

indigenous modality using a lot of the basic human dynamics to be in deep relationship with each other and form a very fluid open coherent governance um highly generative produces a large gradient or a large well of potential but then as it structures itself into the conscious design mode it starts creating an organizational structure it plays the various tools and in many ways kind of replicates The Arc of social structures in general recreating the rise and fall of civilizations and then form some form of closure that eventually dies since I think it's studied pretty thoroughly in a number of different locations

um

and given that languaging and I haven't actually brought in parasite which is a very good you know so it's just bringing parasite and the notion of Niche right so a general principle of evolution is that every Niche will be ultimately explored and there's something about both the presence of entropy in design constructs or actually any any kind of uh gradient or any any kind of gradient has a dynamic of entropy but it also has the dynamic of once the gradient is produced that gradient represents a niche and the exploration and exploitation of that niche of which parasitism is one uh fundamental strategy seems to be something that needs to be we need to be aware of and think about how that's addressed

across different apocs
um and then the the last piece I would
throw out is something like okay uh if
we're endeavoring to move into a third
mode which would be something like the
apoc of conscious evolutionary approach
which is able to sort of combine the
best of the both and perhaps avoid the
negatives of both by the way entirely by
hypothesis they have no reason to
believe this is I have no compelling
reason to believe this is actually
plausible

um

one of the things that might be
interesting is to look at the phenotype
genotype Dynamic I.E Evolution seems to
have woven at a very deep level
uh what I'll call a modal a very
profound modal shift which is that all
phenotypes die
but there's continuity in the phenotype
produces

uh a embodied version of the genotype so
the genotype has continuity exclusively
however mediated by the phenotype and
the phenotype has a kind of continuity
but exclusively mediated by the genotype
and the two are very very distinct in
terms of their physical characteristics
right the things that are associated
with energetic gradients are
qualitatively distinct and the shifting
back and forth between the two seems to
be a solution to the kind of problem
that we're actually talking about
um okay so that's what I'm putting into
the into the mix into the stew

number of ingredients to work with
um yeah so beginning
at the beginning of your statement with
respect to uh the introduction of [___]
uh hike and
um tainter
so the
just give me some grammatic work I think
we have to do as well here because
there's uh
he used the word closure a couple of
times and uh the manner in which he used
it uh was sort of uh and sort of the
epoch ending book and context uh in a
way is that does that is that a fair
characterization of how you you felt you
were using it in a way is that sort of
yeah it has like the closing of uh the
closing of an era the end of an error
the end of a phase I think even even
more pointedly to the notion of a uh a
thermodynamically closed system
these kinds of systems the proposition
I'm making is that they are closed
systems and so therefore they have a uh
a finite time until they achieve
something like an entropic equilibrium
and that sort of does that that Arc of
the playing out of that time is the
story of their of their of their
particular I would propose
okay interesting yeah and I mean so
there's always there's always there's
this fascinating tension along the lines
of sort of uh stable or unstable
equilibriums or you know if you if you
want to layer in another I'm not sure
how familiar you are the work of Terence

Deacon but he's quite interesting in so far as he provides thermodynamic Frameworks around the ideas of uh different um emergent behaviors that flow from sort of this first homeodynamic level which is systems that tend to be uh um that tend to essentially equilibrium so so he introduced a little bit of language called the ortho grade as a sort of abstract general term of like a number of systems that tend toward a uh a more homogeneous State let's say or a more stable State and then Contra grade which is essentially the capacity of any system to given an ambient orthograde context to to sort of act against that in some way um continuously or with some degree of stability and he builds a framework of um you know actually showing that certain types of um structure itself and this kind of resonates with a lot of Kaufman's work in terms of uh the the origins of order looking for non-evolutionary just uh physical constraints that give Horizon processes that interact with those physical constraints that themselves give rise to certain forms of order in the world so uh you know Deacon's claim is something along the lines of two types of systems that might themselves tend toward stable more dissipative structure if put in relationship in a particular way with one another can then give rise to at that sort of frustration boundary afloat

through that frustration boundary give rise to some sort of actual structure in the world or pattern in the world and the architectural example he uses there is something called like a Rayleigh Bernard cell which is heat trying to our energy trying to flow through uh water or oil at a with a particular viscosity um and you know the first thing you get is the actual bubbling of the heat rising but at a particular point the energy can't escape efficiently enough so it actually takes on the test the structure of you know hexagonal lattice so you get these little cells right and um if you've ever been to like the Pacific Northwest or other areas with like Basalt uh rock with these hexagonal columns you can actually see this exact thing embodied when lava cools and then cools and tries to cool release that energy in the same way and performs these giant hexagon hexagonal Rock structures

um in any case my whole point of introducing that line of thought is that I think that there are with respect to you know homeodynamic systems uh this idea of closure is an interesting one because people are researchers such as the commodity or Kaufman as well with his work cycles and uh montavilla masu they have this idea of constraint closures which is why I went in this direction which is deeply tied into the question of in their idea of their conception uh they they use the concept of a of a constraint as sort of

a symmetry across time

um and so that symmetry across time uh

think of something like an enzyme right

the enzyme has its own structure that is

maintained across time but in its

interaction with some other process it

sort of locally breaks that symmetry to

produce a transformation and it sort of

acts as a sort of you could look at it

as like a like a functional or dynamical

um like boundary that also changes what

bounces off of it and then if you order

these boundaries in a particular way you

know and close that Loop which is where

you get this closure which is in many

ways the way that I I tend to use the

word closure these days the reason I'm

laying this groundwork is just because

this idea of closure is very fundamental

the kind of ways I've been thinking

about this particular topic of emergency

governance

um if you know once that becomes closed

uh then you can start talking about

these patterns of Auto catalysis uh

whether that's a self-reinforcing loop

and what it actually self-reinforces uh

and to the extent that we're talking

about governance uh I think it's

relevant because of the fact that at

each one of those points right there are

aspects there are side effects of that

of that function that are the inputs of

one of these other functions but then

there are also side effects that can

have uh other uh functions in the

context in which disclosure might exist

and I think when we're talking about

governance and the the life cycle of
governance we might be talking about
something like that initial closure
coming into being functionally such that
it's overall net byproducts might be
adaptive but to the extent we become
reflexive in understanding this is that
conscious evolution is conscious
management to the extent that we can
identify the closure and start mapping
it and actually and analyzing the points
and the flows within our own minds as
individuals we can start playing games
with it to the extent that that closure
and its side effects shift to a point
where you know it actually shunts
perhaps some of that energy that should
be going to the Adaptive capacity of the
overall closure into sort of sub games
of people's individual political
Dynamics personal lives wealth building
Endeavors that are within their own
frame of reference but not represented
in that closure that they are now able
to see and take advantage of right which
you you might also introduce laterally
and things with the cantion effect where
it's like if you're close to the money
spigot and you see the game that's being
played you are more capable of taking
literally that energy that's being
released into the market and directing
it into places that you know might be
more to your own interests even if you
are saying and claiming that they're in
the general interest of that that
broader Collective closure that we've
created uh supposedly in the economic

sense by the FED to to maintain
homeostatic or homeodynamic stability at
this this financial level so you know
when you kind of bring in those those
Concepts they're very resonant with the
way I've been thinking about it but um I
just wanted to sort of establish that
context for Grammar with respect to
closure because I think it's quite
critical to the way I've also been
thinking about these tendencies
yeah that was great thank you
um so
with regard to that so the that last
Point
um when we're looking at the particular
phenomenon or in human endeavor of
governance we have a special case and I
like I think this is very interesting to
be able to focus so the general case we
could talk about in the context of folks
like uh tainter and uh [___] and Hayek
which is just things that happen in
human-built kinds of organizational
systems that have these various Dynamics
built in governance is particular
because it's of that sort however the
whole point of governance it is in fact
designed to be the thing that addresses
the problematic you were just discussing
right and so the whole point is actually
the recursion or the microcosmic
boundary where governance is is itself
subject to its own uh
and we'll call right now I guess I guess
we'll use closure I'm not quite sure if
I'm even using it right because that was
a lot he was put in there but the uh

sort of the failure conditions that we're talking about and of course you can then imagine that kind of an infinite regress of okay we'll do the government it's on governance and then the governance on the governance on governance just is there uh reason to believe that there's actually a way to uh find a loopback whereby that that actually that whole meta system actually has something like a higher level of stability and and you and you raise them a lot of different points in the very beginning in terms of the three basic questions of what the word stability might even mean it might it might not mean that it lasts forever in fact rarely would it but it might mean that it fails really interestingly so that you know like like the biological organism I die I don't live forever but but my life might be part of a larger Arc that has a completely different continuity process and and that's actually the thing that we're thinking about the song I might die interestingly and so that's a very different solution to the basic problem right

um

okay what else was in there there was something really really interesting where I kind of tried to focus okay so um I noticed also the the this uh the I'll call it geometry so almost like the the third mode so we discussed you discussed the um you know a characteristic and dissipative systems where relationships between two

different structured possibility spaces

um produces a new

um architecture it actually produces

order at a purely physical level

and um and I would say this is something

like there's there's

principles of physics or principles of

nature that are as fundamental as

thermodynamics and because they're as

fundamental they constrain the playing

out of thermodynamics

um

and it's important to recognize we

actually have that that's in the toolkit

we can use this and one of the things

that I was thinking about is that that

one of the things that oftentimes shows

failure conditions in human Design

Systems is

vertical or horizontal asymmetry you

know so for example

if if I have like one person endeavoring

to govern but let's just use it actually

in business that we actually the

ordinary sort of business organization

the notion of span of control in

military and in and for all

bureaucracies it's pretty well

understood but if I have a manager or a

business governance function

um they generally can't actually govern

more than a small number of other people

right so if I have a single manager when

governance functioning they're

indifferent in governance say 500 000

people that asymmetry in terms of

information like I think in terms of

information Theory perception sense

making uh and effective Choice making
that can be actuated down will create a
wide variety of gaps and niches for
parasitism but

maybe there's something to be found in
the context of a proper geometry where
the information asymmetry is inside of
some sort of of conscious boundary like
we came to think about in terms of
what's actually possible in terms of the
space of Consciousness how we can
produce larger spaces of Consciousness
and then how we can actually design
information flow through within that
space so that every

um

[Music]

every flow is actually held within
within a governance envelope that
doesn't produce these niches for
parasitism

yeah yeah I mean 100 that's very
resonant I think that

in that context so so to pick apart this
this is symmetry asymmetry question a
bit more

this relates to you know there's sort of
a long line of uh or undercurrent of
political science that's not that not as
popular that sort of flows through you
know like Machiavelli mosca Burnham you
know that that vein of just pointing out
the the

side effects of this kind of asymmetry
with respect to the idea of leadership
or sort of the ratification of any
system uh in so far as it must take
place within a subset of the population

it can't be like even the idea of democratic governance itself has to be acted out on the day-to-day by a fraction of the entire group uh on behalf of which is being played out in theory and so that that subset of people who are identified

um

are then you know they become responsible for for enacting that game with a particular degree of integrity and I think that that concept of Integrity this is really this kind of relates to the maybe the quality of those governance envelopes you're talking about in the structure uh but also the scope and scale over which uh perhaps responsibility is one way of thinking about it but then also accountability because I think to some extent that accountability transparency game and to the extent more and more people are playing off out their lives uh while trusting you to do the right thing especially you know part of that's going to mean that more of their resources are falling into you with that trust which increases the incentives for you to potentially uh do something that they will not see you know while their eyes are directed elsewhere it's kind of like I like to use the game of you know if there's a the more money that's in the pot on the table right the more you have to be careful going to the bathroom during the game if everyone leaves the room and you just leave one guy in there uh you know you got to be a little bit

careful because even if that's a very trustworthy person at that table you know it the larger that puck gets you know you start beginning to trust uh to test that that degree of integrity and that's kind of that that same asymmetry is like the better system of government the best systems of governments that create the more of the systems we create to generate value if they are actually successful it is exactly that value that's created by them that becomes the Temptation for defection and and and so this is very interesting with respect to this envelope question because it it transforms into this accountability and representation question I think uh and to the extent that we are forced to represent these systems or to have accountability with these systems I think we live in a very interesting time because we are beginning to be able to have uh you know representative granularity and transparency in ways that were never before possible even and then and using those to sort of act as proxies for maintaining integrity and binding constraints on people's behavior and it's an interesting balance because we obviously you know if someone is a representative uh we want those people to enact the highest ideal in theory of their representative position uh that being said uh we also need to have that position be somewhat attractive and uh to the extent that anyone is is looking to act out that position if it is fully

constrained and surveilled they might no longer be interested in taking on that position so you see you might have to you know one solution to that might be something along the lines of like well automate the whole thing but but humans don't like as embodied beings humans don't tend to respond well to the idea of an abstract entity that they don't really fully understand the internals and that kind of aren't actually hitting our mirror neurons in the right way either like we're not getting that reflective property of like yes I intuitively understand this thing I think we get also innately suspicious whenever the idea of some sort of abstract system uh you know acting as our representative or acting as our governance even if that were fully transparent and less likely to defect against us or provably would not defect against us like we might just rebel against it anyway so we there's sort of this possible Catch-22 there so so those are some I guess some thoughts there yeah that's interesting so oh that that one that last piece it's let me see how that's right the last piece which was called the AI governance piece um it's kind of there's no kind of worthy it's tremendously worthy of a really serious Deep dive and maybe sooner rather than later right we're actually accelerating in the direction where that kind of Science Fiction narrative is

um plausibly and let's not say like we don't know these things happen in Step functions they don't tend to go in a straight a curve uh but plausibly is on the Event Horizon so we may actually have to wrestle with that I would propose though I cannot prove it um with adequate rigor and so it would require a collaborative effort but I propose that is in fact that idea can't work and there's actually I believe an actual rigorous proof that is available that the notion of a fully automated government system is intrinsically unstable but that doesn't mean that we won't try to do it and trap ourselves thereby

um so let me let me back up a little bit before we get there because we can talk about the stuff that's sort of in between and uh this is very much the tainter the tanter story more or less right so we get we get the idea of um so the first movement is is the relationship between contextualization and decontextualization

um which may be the thing that humans specifically most fundamentally do is the ability to decontextualize we can pull the Salient elements of some particular landscape out as we see fit right not just

um by virtue of evolutionary Fitness we can actually fluidly identify characteristics that we'd like to pop into the foreground and sort of reify down into principles and then most specifically Endeavor to govern I.E to

optimize for or against or modulate
according to our own preferences
um and of course one of the things that
we can do with that power of
decontextualizations we can then design
architectures uh on the basis of that
decontextualization which is the the
term technology that's what that means
right technology is a the ability to
decontact use decontextualization to uh
design in nature uh phenomena that are
specifically optimizing for particular
principles
um that we've been able to pull out of
of what is otherwise a larger a larger
million
um and I would propose that this is at
the basis of both the strength and the
weakness of the the design like the
epoch of design and
the limitations of decontextualization
are very deeply woven into the fragility
or the problematic of say tantric style
curves the high all the things that
we're talking about so uh you know of
course in the process of
decontextualization on the one hand
we're able to identify What's called the
most the most relevant or the most
Salient characteristics of some system
and then we can begin to control for
them okay I want I want more calories
per unit yield of wheat
um but of course the the inverse is also
True by virtue of decontextualization we
move away from the ability to have high
quality perception of all of the other
things that are going on in that

embedded system so we lose track of them
and by virtue of losing track of them to
the degree to which they matter and of
course now we're getting into kind of
like uh
something around Heisenberg and deep
chaos theory meaning tiny tiny
differences microcosmic differences
possibly at the plank limit tend to
build up into large consequences so that
as we decontextualize we render into the
invisible we render out of the realm of
design out of the realm of the conscious
a whole bunch of things that were in
fact by definition calculated via
relevant relevance realization at the at
the unconscious evolutionary level just
by you know sheer actual having causal
effect on the system and then of course
we're setting ourselves up we're setting
ourselves up to have unintended
consequences Cascade out into our larger
environment and then what we tend to do
then this is the the tantric move the
thing that I want to kind of bring into
the into the foreground is that we tend
to double down so what we do is we will
briccollage or we will cluge new
technologies at the edge oh okay this
particular problem is showing up great
I'm going to do the same move I'm going
to look at that problem foreground or
Decon texture realize the elements that
I can identify in the problem
put together a new technology connected
to the previous technology we kind of
get one of these um remember building
mobiles when you're a kid you can kind

of add something at the balance point
and it can kind of layers layers down
um and of course the the point that
somebody like tainted very specifically
makes and I think [___] also maybe not
quite as clearly makes is that we then
get lost in our own creation right the
the machine that we have built is has so
much complicatedness to it it has so
much
um so many different things going on
that we're no longer actually able to do
Master of our own machine and this moves
us back into an unconscious design phase
right so now we're effectively
maintaining something that we don't
understand in many cases
Our Generations past its origin stories
we've actually you know we have a tiny
window of awareness in a much larger
field that larger field doesn't have the
advantage of a tightly coupled deeply
nuanced complex fully contextualized
characteristic instead it actually has
lots of these little decontextualization
gaps foregrounds and backgrounds but
we're super not aware of it if you've
lost track of it a lot and now this is
part of the niche environment every one
of those gaps becomes a niche for
various forms of parasitism or become
places where local entropy is is
collected and can't be addressed because
they're effectively in various kinds of
blind spots or in what what the Santa Fe
people would call Frozen accidents of
our own complicated Machinery I.E it's
just a gap that that arose because the

way that we built the control system and
for us to actually just address the Gap
we have to deconstruct the control
system but the game theory doesn't work
the cost of deconstructing the control
system is something that we're not
willing to do to so the local entropy
just gathers and gathers and gathers
until it festers and it eventually
creates a breakage that we sort of
unconsciously just accepted as what's
going to happen

um

okay I think that that sort of played
out what I had there

I can hear you by the way I'm just gonna
get some more water

okay yeah no problem no problem

um yeah and and so

I mean that that obviously ties into the
dynamic of you know sort of at the more
colloquial level the fact that uh that
humans don't act in general creatures
biological organisms but especially
humans that are in theory through one
lens

known to be the kind of creature that
attempts to to look into the the future
The Horizon of possibility and and
attempt to act in line with uh a manner
in which that that feature uh remains
habitable let's say uh but then there's
always this long-term short-term tension
with respect to you know at what point
does the you know do the do the possible
thresh do the potential threats start to
uh realize themselves or actualize
themselves at levels that generate

sufficient uh sufficient you get to call
entropy or suffering or you know
something that sort of shakes you
strongly enough to to actually or deeply
enough to change Behavior or your frame
of reference at the appropriate uh scale
to produce transformation that uh can
respond to whatever that blind spot that
you're mentioning by the process of
decontextualization uh whatever that
whatever has been manifesting in that
blind spot that is then threatening the
Integrity of the process or the the
capacity of that process to to maintain
continuity across time one thing that
really struck me that's interesting as
well and I think yeah I guess I've been
playing around with a lot of these types
of ideas lately in terms of uh with
respect to words and the the sort of
inversion capacities or cyclic
capacities of taking a concept and and
flipping it and seeing what happens this
idea of decontextualization is
fascinating to me because you know
when you're discussing it uh in my mind
something that's popping up is is
another like way of looking at this very
phenomenologically is that if you if we
look at ourselves as categorizing beings
attempting to attempting to and to me
what categorizing beings tends to mean
is is having a functional attractor of
some sort that we're binding
representations to with this sort of
agglomerative tendency of more and more
things that have that likeness or
sameness or are associated with that

network uh building over time
um one of the the essential
characteristics is that we can't focus
on everything at a given point in time
and therefore we have to live inside a
given framework that mediates
facilitates and and hones our
attentional capacity to actually
navigate that process of of using this
category structure to relate to
actualities and possibilities
continuously across time and so
interestingly enough
the context of that ambiance and one way
of looking at decontextualization might
also be a process of hyper
contextualization in the sense where we
are taking a very small representative
Subspace uh we're identifying a
particular set of Concepts like you know
I think abstraction is a way of looking
at this right like you're saying there's
a set of similarities here and they're
graspable enough within my mind at the
moment so I'm going to take those and
then begin to act as if I'm living
inside those as the full context right
and so like through that zooming in to
the abstraction or to that to that
subset of the possible pattern space I
begin to act as if that subset is the
entire Ambiance and therefore become
blind to everything that is not inside
that Subspace and so you're sort of
living inside the Micro Niche this micro
gradient because you identified a useful
gradient inside that abstraction for
some uh some perhaps instrumental or or

even you know even something that was truly convincing like um you know the idea of calculus is extremely compelling and we got a great deal of adaptive utility out of that concept but does it hit a limit at some level in terms of like the metaphors and the way of seeing the world through the lens of calculus does it start to break down I mean I would argue yes I think there there are boundaries when you start to see the world as a set of instance when with respect to my studies in Consciousness and and like the emergence of Consciousness and topology of Consciousness I think one of the things that actually has done you know inhibits us quite a bit is trying to think of it as an instantaneous property of a system something that could in theory be pointed out as a as a a point on a tangent curve somewhere right like um so in any case like this recontextual decontextualization Frame I think is a very deep frame and and part of this phenomenological tendency we have to see patterns and then start living with inside those patterns as an Adaptive framework and then just to close this off I guess with respect to the coonian take on that as well you know in his he's well known for structural scientific revolutions but my favorite essay by [___] is uh an essay called the essential tension which is like the essay in which she kind of responds to the public response to his structure of Scientific Revolution speaking in front

of I think it was the APA or something
like that at the time and you know
saying

I essentially have been largely
misinterpreted by people who want to use
that work as a justification for
throwing off all constraints but in
reality what he was saying this
essential detention was like uh there's
a frame that's established a very formal
rigid frame and the point of that formal
rigid frame and discipline is to move to
a point of convergence not because of
the convergence point is the
transcendental ideal that we absolutely
must get to but because by acting as if
that convergence process is worth
um worth moving toward as we converge we
will realize what is outside of that
cone of convergence so to speak it'll
start showing up as aberrations and then
by collecting those aberrant pieces of
information we can begin to realize oh
okay this is how we can print in a
principled and structured and continuous
manner uh once again open that frame
back up

um
recontextualize the decontextualization
or or like Zoom back out of that hyper
Focus contextualization

um and and synthesize a new frame that
doesn't just jettison the value of the
previous frame uh arbitrarily but that
also isn't myopically focused Beyond a
point of critical uh uh critical
collapse let's say
um on pursuing that singular

interpretation of the the old frame and
so I think to some extent like this is
the set of patterns that were that we're
trying to work with when we talk about
and we're we're trying to one I think
we're we're instead of the structure
scientific
revolutions were like beginning to see
you know is it we're beginning to see
the traces of like the necessity of that
analogous process occurring at the
structural level of governance and and
this this is sort of the Zeitgeist of
our ERA with many people attempting to
to place ideas Place new frame
possibilities and which how should we
direct our attention uh into the the
space of public discussion and uh
hopefully experimentation and try to
figure out
um can we get some positive signals so
that as this prior frame begins to
disintegrate
um are there are there lifeboats that
are actually capable of carrying more
than one to five people at a time
yeah so
um it's notable that that uh you know
tanter referred to it as the collapse of
complex societies and
um I think the proper way of describing
what [__] was describing was not so much
of paradigm shift as a paradigm
catastrophe and
um I think there's a very specific point
there we're actually looking for
Paradigm Shift you know it's like hey I
got a paradigm okay now it's time to

shift in that movement and I I would like to very much evoke here the uh uh cognitive science Notions of opponent processing and how the brain very specifically in you know all the way down to the most basic animals uses modal distinction specifically what I was thinking about is very much the dynamic we're okay where it's time to focus on a very localized task but there's something happening at a meta level

that allows and requires in fact is Shifting back to diffuse and then moving back and forth right and that that notion of modal distinction right brain left brain distinction are qualitatively different in how they go about uh orienting towards where to allocate attention and even how to do um sense making in the relationship to perception and then there's a meta Dynamic that moves back and forth between them right so that kind of a tricameral structure

um at a very very deep modal distinction or qualitatively distinct level seems like it's uh the proper design for any kind of new kind of collective intelligence

and uh I was brought to mind of the of the distinction between thinking and simulated thinking that I was trying to make gosh about five years ago um and I think that was that was oftentimes also not fully grasped so if you wouldn't mind I'll just recapitulate because the point is very specifically

the point

um

that we have we have very we have two modes at least but definitely two modes of thinking right one mode that I called habit mode one mode that I called explore mode and I was I'm not necessarily trying to say that I invented any of this and there are many people I'm sure have done a much better job I was trying to point out the thing I'm trying to point out is not that um but the idea that habit mode like Paradigm is able to take advantage of a variety of different Frameworks that are relatively well designed for a particular domain and therefore quickly and accurately and predictably be able to make sense and select appropriate choices in the context of a certain domain right that's a very functional thing to have explore mode is a mode that is modally distinct has a more diffuse awareness much more contextually aware is oriented towards things like Insight I.E breaking existing assumptions and very very oriented towards the subtle things that may not ordinarily be noticed in habit mode but may actually be relevant and that's why we have to have this different Explorer right so the The Meta process is okay which mode should I be in right now am I am in a context where Explorer mode is the most adaptive mode or am I a context for habit mode is the most adaptive mode and can I fluidly move back and forth right so that's that that third right so

I've got one two three and the premise of this notion of simulated thinking is that there's something about habit mode where we can get stuck in it so it somehow habit mode breaks this third governance layer that allows us to fluidly move back and forth and then gets us more and more stuck in habit mode in particular where we begin to build a habit that simulates governance right and then and then we're in trouble because at that point we can't actually make proper use of explore mode because we actually haven't got the capacity all we can do is when the governance system is saying hey it's time to move to explore mode habit mode says oh I've got it and then produces something vaguely like explore mode but still within the fundamentals of habitat and you can you can sort of extend that to all the different examples we've used right this operates in every Dynamics you know so in Coon's model it would be anomalies are being thrown and the larger system is saying hey there's something wrong with our Paradigm but but the the paradigmatic mind says well I'll just produce a more complex version of my existing Paradigm to absorb those anomalies into it or I'll use the function of ignoring in other words I'll put them into a an area of local entropy and just kind of let them sit for however long maybe forever ideally right and the you know the meta premise is that's the problem right that is the problem of conscious design is

that getting stuck and not actually
having the opponent processing built
robustly enough that we can move from
habit into Explorer without having to go
through a crisis right the problem is is
not that we sometimes our habits aren't
functional we have to move to a
different mode the problem is sometimes
we get addicted to our habits and the
only we can get out of them is actually
to go through hitting rock bottom and
that's a very very un adaptive way of
solving that kind of problem

so yeah yeah and um and just to sort of
like to

test the language a bit and make sure
that I'm I'm with you here and uh also
use it potentially to synthesize some of
the the topics that we've been talking
about

um

it's fascinating to consider this in
light of of this question so in terms of
parasitism that we've been talking about
and also the question of uh the benefits
of parasitism possibly right because
you're talking about this this
catastrophic or this catastrophe which
is in you know dynamical systems in many
ways analogous to to falling off a
cliff

um like in the map that is actually
exactly like that anyways

um and so uh

it could be it could be the case right
that one way of looking at parasitism if
you can if you can endogenize it or if
you can actually internalize some amount

of it or look at it as a property of systems is is potentially as a smoothing function for that Cliff insofar as you know this gradient that we were talking about before

um in light of the language you're talking about

in terms of uh this habit mode right and exploration mode uh with respect to Collective governance or Collective uh systems used for simulating this adaptive process as a collective

um that Collective process of governance can at times be in that exploration mode potentially discovering some new form so if you you look at like the Inception of our you know the nation of the United States and there's a lot of synthesis happening a lot of different ideas you know from a you know lineage you know extending thousands of years into history uh drawing from all of that to try to synthesize a particular novel framework

um it was very conscious hyper-conscious hypersynthetic very exploratory

um but it created something that in its stability and efficacy became so functionally stable that more and more people were able to move into habit mode with respect to that as a foundation and as that happens uh interestingly enough it opens up uh little exploratory niches for actors to go in and say are there micro gradients in that system because of the fact that all these people are on habit mode no longer their attention is focused outwards it's no longer you know

a 10 ending inwards and so they actually go in and and start siphoning energy perhaps uh in their own Explorer modes as perhaps parasitic Behavior Uh from this governance Loop but interestingly enough that can focus uh that can function as a way of um testing the stability of that Loop to some extent like they are uh

forcing that fundamental functional closure of governance that people have stopped attending to on Moss generally uh they're forcing it to operate under additional constraints under additional load even though that load like that's an internal load that it might not have necessarily been formally designed to Bear but that parasitism you know like a parasite load on any animal is forcing that animal to operate

um over and above what they would have to do otherwise without that parasitic load and so it's actually building some slack into the system perhaps such that when people when people when we start when things start getting shaky and people turn their attention back into that system see the parasites and potentially get rid of them there's still enough slack left in that mechanism hopefully to navigate uh the the cliff or you know to smooth the cliff so that's like a possibility I'm not really I'm not sure how coherent that was if that made sense I mean let me know but

it maps to I believe pretty almost exactly to Brett Weinstein's um story

about uh peacock Tales of pyramids
so his argument this is effectively
peacock tails and pyramids are exactly
what you're talking about the defective
of the peacock Tails not just a pure
sort of sexual display but it's actually
effectively a parasitic Reservoir that
provides a Fail-Safe that to the degree
to which the context no longer supports
it you can lose a lot of [___] tail
get back a huge amount of adaptive
capacity without losing any real
holistic
um total uh Fitness and respond to
what's happening same thing with
pyramids like if you put a lot of social
uh
excess would that be called Surplus into
pyramids as opposed to say for example
more people
your carrying capacity is actually
buffered so that if there's actually a
significant uh drought where food
production is not as high as it was you
just stop building as many pyramids and
you don't actually have a cash problem
collapse of the underlying deep
structure was that in his thesis or I
haven't heard him talk about that uh
surprisingly I've heard him before
so I may have just added them I
apologize for some reason I thought it
was like I was like yeah because
um in the hunter-gatherers guide that
one or yeah and uh maybe I I've haven't
watched I don't know I need to reflect
back on it I don't it didn't yeah it
might be there but um yeah that's it

precisely yeah I mean it's certainly not surprising to be like Brett and the mind that Brett has in the way that he thinks uh I think you and I tend to dovetail and converge to a lot of similar frames of reference so that's yeah but I mean I think precisely that these abilities to um maintain higher carrying capacities within any given system fundamentally provide slacking in that system and you know we look at it if we look at it just at the object level and and you know through almost entirely moral framework uh then uh it can it can it can lead us to believe that there's no benefit here and to perhaps be a little bit overly acerbic in our language toward what's going on interestingly enough it might have been selected for we might be selected precisely uh you know in the same way that it's we have some interesting side effects of psychopathy that might have uh overall adaptive side effects that small levels in society uh some element of sort of corruption and parasitism uh at a base level within even healthy systems might be optimal um to the extent we can talk about optimality in such a system and so um and that might and then knowing that might uh my bravest against becoming overly cynical right um because I think that at some levels the at some level the the greatest threat to our current capacity for adaptation uh is a abundance of cynicism uh and an abundance uh and like innervating quality of that cynicism

with respect to sapping us of the the
necessary will energy and belief that
that we can actually do anything that is
uh that is worth doing so nice Daniel
how much time do we have left
25 minutes but I'm happy to stay on
anytime you want to feel free to
continue this section and then we can go
into q a

I have another piece that I'd love to
drop in right here
um so let's see yeah
the psychological consequences of being
stuck

and

um

almost like the psychosocial
consequences like the feedback loop so
on the one hand you have the interior
psychology of being in something like
simulated thinking

um where you can't get out of your own
habits of thought and you can't
escape into a higher level of insight
you can't escape back into explore mode
but also the feedback loops are being
stuck in a collapse and complex society
where uh explore mode is in fact
inhibited because it doesn't have any
place to get energy or resource for
example or positive feedback the energy
resource and all the different human
needs modalities and so what happens
when you're in there and what happens
there is you start getting things like
you get depressed
um you get cynical you get nihilistic
you get anemia right

um

okay so let me think okay I'll do it

three things first that notion of

parasitism as a as a reservoir of

potential is very interesting and I can

think about that immediately in in two

ways two examples that pop up uh one is

that the notion of like eighty percent

85 of people are in so-called [__]

jobs or at least self-reported

um which I think is very very reasonable

particularly if you sort of think about

the Cascade effects

um meaning if you were to remove a whole

category of [__] jobs you would

realize there's a whole other set of

jobs that are actually [__] jobs

produced entirely by the first category

so if you start unwinding them well on

the one hand that's terrible right I

mean people are wasting their lives and

their energy and just spinning on the

other hand oh that's really good because

that actually means that I've got sort

of 80 of the human population is sitting

on the sideline waiting to be deployed

generatively as soon as we can get our

head out of our ass right that's nice to

catch both ways

um I also recall during the the

2008-2010 financial crisis

I'm saying okay well how far down does

this system actually call it need to

fall for truly robust reset I.E if the

too big to fail systems have been

allowed to fail properly which is what

should have happened what would that

have looked like

it's like well we're probably not going to drop below like a 1972 level of standard of living like that's a pretty big fall from where we are right now and I recall the 1972 was actually pretty nice and it wasn't a terrible style of life and the point being that there's almost something like the uh what are they called the like the F-350 hyper truck well it turns out that if if we have to actually give up our F350 and just scale back down to an F-150 oh that's actually not that bad we'll survive that's not that's not a catastrophe right that's actually a pretty decent amount of fat built into the system that we can allow to cut back and not lose our [___] now the challenge of course is can we do that elegantly so then I'll get to the third piece um everything that I'm about to say is from my opponent is entirely hypothetical I am making up this story on the basis of some some heuristics but the the notion is something like this kind of dynamic of um modal uh uh opponent processing and some kind of system that that catalyzes the movement back and forth between them is is very very old like deeply fundamental it's too important not to be woven in like the obviously the sympathetic sympathetic nervous system um go way back all right so that basic structure is super fundamental and shows up all over the place all right second humans at the at the kind of the first apoc indigenous humans almost certainly

therefore would have used that at the
social level right we would not have
been able to achieve something like a
social cultural style of collective
intelligence that didn't also have this
kind of structure woven and deeply but
it would have been woven in deeply
using embodied cognition obviously not
design cognition because we weren't at
the design recognition apoc so what does
that mean what does it look like the
proposition is something like
when the external context when the
conditions that we're in
are signaling a need to move to a group
explore mode exiting paradigmatic
obligate paradigmatic mind or stuckness
exiting habit mode into a more liminal
form of collective intelligence
there's a every distinct human at an
embodied level will sense that
differentially
and they will subtly begin to signal
that differentially back into the
collective environment I'll give that
concrete and so
um

it's been raining less and less
we don't have concepts of of rainfall we
don't have meteorology like there's a
long [__] time ago but we notice in a
very fundamental sense our bodies are a
little bit more dehydrated or the energy
necessary to get water a little bit
higher we're noticing the prey animals
are reduct are not as common we're
noticing that uh yield of food is
decreasing noticing at the physical

level deep deep stuff like biological
and then there's different types of
humans right we have a different
typology we have old women we have young
women we have young men we have children
we have older men right there's all and
probably I'm guessing something on the
order of like
7 to 40 cognitive typologies that cover
the different
um kind of modes of reality that it's
useful to have strengths and weaknesses
in it right so this is a there's a
collective intelligence that the
indigenous level is constructive
typological differences each of those
typological differences will have
differentials and sensitivity to the
subtle signals of is it time for us to
actually move to a new Niche do we need
to leave the valley and go into the
mountains because the rainfall is
telling us that flood time is about to
come that kind of thing right and it
will show up in Behavior that's the key
thing like actual physical behavior
um physical Behavior will produce a
second order feedback loop right as I
notice the older women behaving in a
different way it signals me in an
embodied level to begin and the ACT adds
additional differential signal to my own
perception
and then we'll change my behavior and so
when I'm noticing for example that the
young women are giving attention and
perhaps sexual access to a different
kind of behavior in men very clearly

this will change the behavior in young men but that also will cause to tend to Cascade throughout the larger environment so the idea is there's something like a a very very complex set of multi-typological feedback loops pulling in subtle information from the context that will eventually catalyze a pivot from tribal paradigmatic locked in very functional and effective adaptive habit mode into okay let's all sit around the fire hand off the comp from the chief to the shaman let's talk about the oldest deepest mythological stories hey Elders are you aware of anything like a very different mode right um the premise I'm making is that that's actually the case I'm going to argue that we have that that a large part of what's actually going on like characteristics like depression and cynicism are feel like frustration you know how frustration works right frustration is when there's a deeply felt sense that there needs to be some change in the world that is building up energy to make the change but the change can't the path to the change can't actually be produced and the energy effectively feeds back on itself right that's the energy of frustration which eventually will either build to a release this way or it will uh come to a feed it'll cut itself up to the source and then it will lead to more like depression right so that's a proposed like to put out there

that we're in a moment a big part of
what's going on is that we're all
receiving the signal that we need to
shift into this
um Collective Consciousness mode this
liminality mode this this group explore
mode we don't know how and we're largely
stuck and so we're trying to figure out
how to make that move at very micro
level like there's lots and lots of
adaptive stuff going on not the least of
which is the Brokenness of our body mind
our body is in our mind in relationship
to just reality ideology overriding our
signals like in body cognition is way
out of whack
um and a big big chunk maybe even like
90 of the chunk of the problem they're
actually dealing with is the Journey of
Simply restoring ourselves to that basic
capacity once we get back to that basic
capacity unlocking the 80 of people who
are sitting in [__] jobs back into a
coherent collective intelligence that's
operating in a group explore mode
has enough capacity to actually navigate
us to the niche we want to get to so
that's a
I've taken the problem of governance and
say okay that's actually we can take a
series of steps and think about how do
we maybe find a way to work our our path
how do we find the path to get us back
to the location where we regenerate our
ambient indigenous capacity to operate
in this mode from which we should unlock
a vastly larger capacity to think about
these bigger problems right and the end

of point

yeah I mean there's there's a lot there

I think I you know I could go I could go

on a

I I I'm quite the response I don't I

think in terms of time though I I think

Daniel you did want to bring in some

live chat questions as well

um or in terms of where do we want to go

here because I could I could respond to

that there's a lot of really interesting

points there uh or we could weave

questions into that uh that context that

frame

um where do you want to go

Matthew with a direct response then

um we'll have a rapid question and

answer that'll take us just around the

time that we agreed upon and feel free

to depart as well and then at the very

end I'll just make some Reflections and

connect it to active inference so first

Matthew then question and then feel free

to stay or leave and they'll be a little

active reflection

cool yeah and in light of that I was

also really wanting to raise some of the

uh the active inference uh semantics and

context in response to in response to uh

Jordan's points

um one interesting frame that he'll it's

interesting to observe that it hasn't

saturated the culture perhaps just given

the mimetics of when and where is

introduced but

um sort of like EO Wilson and uh Edward

Lumsden introduced something called dual

inheritance Theory uh 20 to 30 years ago

I'm not sure if you you
encountered that they had this book
called uh genes mind and culture and um
there's a lot of residents with respect
to the mechanisms you know they did a
lot of work with respect to the manner
in which the kind of uh diversity of the
behavioral sensitivities
um psychological psychomomatic and like
cultural level sensitivities and
behavioral patterns uh have these kind
of emergent feedback loops that uh that
essentially end up creating a emergent
form of parametrization at the cultural
level and the cultural Dynamics you know
these changes you're talking about at
deeper levels of reality as they bubble
up through and restructure the cultural
manifestations and the sensitivities uh
and behavioral Tendencies of this
diversity of psychotypes I guess you you
were saying how that actually as a as a
mechanism feeds back into uh and back
down through all those other different
layers of adaptive uh mediation
selection transformation
um and sort of like this this emergent
Cascade and then this essentially
reflects the parameters parameterization
which many people have struggled with in
the fat in the past is under the offices
of the argument around downward
causation that's a whole slightly
different conversation but I do think
active inference is very interesting
um
from the perspective at least from my
perspective some of the work I've been

doing recently

showing that in many ways uh active

inference is in it offers a one one

function in the category the necessary

category of transformational mappings

between perception and action that do

exist at this deeply fundamental level

uh in terms of the the sort of

establishment of any causal closures

either you know you know of any

non-trivially complex uh process any any

cycle that's capable of observation and

action based on perception right in

relation to perception

um and interestingly I think that that

does biasure nature in the way that it

connects to itself give rise to this

bimodal topology like through a

particular kind of non-orientability and

so the reflectivity when something comes

back to you has a different orientation

so you actually have an understanding of

um you know the relationship between

past and present via the lens of

duration because of the need to perceive

and then impose some transformation on

the environment through that I think

we're just beginning to develop

the the capacity to

work with those tools in a way that

doesn't uh impose that that's more like

surfing these adaptive waves that allows

us to observe the way in which these

Transformations and perceptions are

mapping onto actions and using that as a

tool and and a potential in a toolkit of

like explicitly and consciously

designing networked connections between

these many different perceivers and actors and their perceptual and action capacities in a way that can um I don't want to say provably but but but prince in a principled manner give rise to emergent systems that do have these properties built in endogenously and perhaps these signaling mechanisms built in endogenously in ways that can resonate with what you're talking about which is the embodied sense that we have intuitively or unconsciously that arises but we don't necessarily have the language or the framework to explicitly talk about it so sort of that that that emergent welling up of emotion or frustration or depression or enemy as you said

um

gets shunted into Language and Cultural symbols and representations that don't fully close back on the on the sort of actuation capacities that we need to actuate or that we need to upregulate in this particular moment and I think active inference and and other uh Frameworks like it precisely because they take this

perspective epistemic perspective that says actually you don't get to directly observe the world all you can do and the best you can do is take this humble process of of trying the best you can to connect signals of perception to signals of action in relationship to preferences at a given time and the context in which they exist and and build from there uh ground up I think it's it's a leading

candidate in the the modes of
phenomenologically Shifting our
perspective through
um you know through new ways of
operating and seeing the world through
new paradigms through uh new toolkits so
you know that's why I think I've been
you know really interested in the active
inference space and see it as as
something that's quite relevant to this
entire conversation and in particular to
to your sort of final remarks there
all right excellent
awesome thanks both for the dialogue
this is really great so uh I will try to
bring in
many of the questions that were asked in
the very
active and energetic live chat
um
will get pretty quick thoughts that will
conclude the primary section of the
stream and then if you want to stay or
leave but I'll just add a few more
points because indeed the connection
with active inference is very Salient
okay so into the questions we go first
from Charles Bloss hello
what are the primary patterns including
values of wise collaboration
one was the one that you just noticed
which is moving at the pace
of wise collaboration meaning in this
case I noticed that's a very complex
question
I'll have to take a lot of time to think
about it yeah
questions raised yeah we raise the

questions here and explore it in the coming time but feel free to give a short response while you can for sure for sure I mean it's just interesting I think there's a continent there because one of the things that was coming to mind as I was taking the time to try to reflect on that was was patience hey especially in light of all of the tendencies that shift us away from the capacity to take in sufficient information relation uh uh to cycle on that in in a uh to to so there's a tendency to always want to especially under pressure under stress to always want to take perception and immediately map to action right like for every cycle of perception some sort of symmetric action because it feels very it feels uh like you're at least doing something feels better than doing nothing but uh there might be some minimal necessary amount of reflection you might need to cycle a number of times uh at a number of scales with a diversity of opinions before the capacity is built up in that Collective um intelligence or Collective coherent structure before any action that it takes externally can do anything other than make things worse and I think that that's a massive problem that we're confronting right now because most of our tools are designed to map perception to some sort of extrinsic action almost instantaneously and we haven't created the infrastructure that allows us to more deeply uh allow for complex

emergent perception and mediated
mediated in the context of action at the
sort of duration and depth required to
meet the moment
great so then a follow-up comment and
then a question so Charles followed
speaking of time flagging an inquiry in
regard to timekeeping and calendars and
their specific numerics effects on
Humanity's psyche and cultures related
to this patience and Kronos and Kairos
um next question from Nathan Curtis
at what point in time from instantiation
does the established government lose its
ability to be self-referential and able
to look in on itself to identify flaws
I've had it I've had a general thought
about this question
um what I would say of course is that
the answer is is it depends right so the
particulars matter
um and I think it's going to be
something like three primary
characteristics
one isn't going to actually have to do
with the let's call the shape or the
topology of the underlying architecture
so an architecture like say liberalism
has a decent number of uh designed
fail-saves
very specifically conscious consciously
aware of this problem and so it has a
it's more like a dissipative structure
it has a higher capacity to actually
live longer given a particular gradient
we're using the earliest language we
were using
[Music]

um

the second it's funny you can actually
you can basically identify three very
straightforward principles and one is
the the amount of of energy or the
amount of of information or or potential
that was enclosed in the initial uh
design the second is the the
intelligence or Elegance of design in
terms of its actual uh ability to
produce structure that most effectively
uh

navigates that that dissipation into
entropy the third and this is I think a
piece that we're running into a lot is
something like a characteristic of
bandwidths
distinct from time meaning the proper
measure is not chronological time
Chronos but it's something like
relational interactions or Loops of
perception to agency something like that
and so if I think Jose is a kind of a
clock

um

that is the right clock
awesome yeah I mean that that Maps
directly onto you know kind of what I
was mentioning with respect to the
active inference idea of duration as
time right in the sense that that is
precisely that cyclic relation in terms
of perceiving the consequences of action
as perception and then you know
internally inside of whatever mechanism
is perceiving and acting at whatever
scale we're talking about
um you know that transformation is sort

of this this this era of time that we
perceive as as the linear structure that
linear mapping but the real time in a
lot of ways the systemic time is the the
path links through this causal structure
that flows

um between the action of Any Given
entity and uh the the capacity to
perceive feedback uh in terms of what
those actions caused and how that allows
you know in light of the contextualized
relations that give meaning to the
action in light of the values that are
ostensibly pursued and so in getting
back to the question in terms of when is
this system capable of or when does it
become no longer capable of of that kind
of self-reflection well I would say to
the extent that that cyclic time that
capacity that closure for being able to
understand the causal effects of one's
own actions in a contextualized

um
meaning grounded frame to the extent
that that is intercepted or broken right
um

or to the extent that it becomes no
longer concerned with its own
or solipsistic is another way of putting
it so those would be conditions right
it's like to the extent that it actually
uh becomes so

trapped in its own existing frame or its
own assumptions of causality

um so this would be you know in inactive
inference you know you have something
along the lines of

um you have something along the lines of

like an over

um like

the Precision of its its capacity to
represent the world becomes far too
precise with respect to the the the the
relationship between a very narrow
subset of modalities and factors in the
world percepts and actions in the world
which is exactly what we were talking
about earlier when we were talking about
in Jordan's language the
decontextualization or like hyper
contextualization

um and then you know that prevents you
from being able to identify

um a very large percentage of the causal
structure that might be relevant to
whatever is threatening the coherence
of of your collective intelligence or
your actual physically embodied
metabolic systems or or whatever that
may be so

yeah

awesome Nathan bro

if we want those representatives to
embody a certain aspect of being in that
position how do we best select those
people what modalities can we use to
select the best AI recommendation
systems temperament and character
inventory test

I'm a person I'm fascinated by the
possibilities of uh emergent
identification

um of of reputation like networks that
take advantage of of
the information that exists in local
relationships uh we might notice that to

the extent that we have elections at larger and larger scales we lose that right like in your local elections in a democratic election or Democratic electorate

um you know if you're if you're voting for uh for your county like you know for for sort of like a county chair

um or a uh Governor or whatnot you're much more likely to have relationships uh or at least some sort of socially contextualized understanding of of who that person is and what the words that are coming out of their mouth actually mean in relationship to your embodied life

um but the further you get away from that the more you're dealing with abstractions and so the more energy has to be put into making those abstractions feel real to you and then you enter the world of you know television news and political uh news Cycles very myopically focused hyper precise a lot of energy and time put into those particular issues that get the most attention as opposed to those issues that tend to actually have a more embodied effect on on you know an individual so how do you actually take advantage or Surface that that emergent pattern of contextualized wisdom not just within Democratic elections but at at a much deeper level than we've ever considered before because I think

One requirement of meeting the level of complexity of the problems before us is representing a much greater degree of

information which without that
information uh you know and that
information being at many scales of our
net emergent organism being the nation
state let's say for now
um without that information flow through
the system overwhelming the system I
think liquid democracy perspectives as a
general category are quite interesting
in terms of looking at them as as sort
of like graph finding or pathfinding
algorithms of expertise that are
mediated by local expertise or local
relationships local trust networks
um
trick with those is is I think executing
those in a way that is
um that is capture resistant that
doesn't necessarily make that doesn't
turn the entire game of life into a game
of of politics such that uh we are all
campaigning all the time to be perceived
as the greatest expert in whatever
domain without actually producing the
actions that would naturally give rise
to those perceptions it's a big problem
it's like aping aping the taping the
behaviors that would lead to someone
perceiving you as successful it's like
the Instagram model or Instagram
personality problem right it's like if
you rent the Jet Plane and you know put
on the facade and you wear the skin suit
and have the persona it's increasingly
difficult for a large percentage of
people to divorce that from the real
signal itself so I think within liquid
democracy uh patterns of sort of

emergent stewardship or identification of people who might be able to solve problems with greater competence that emerges as a problem and then there's also the problem of response time so it's like to some extent uh the reason why we have Central executives are the reason why we have individual representatives and place Authority in the hands of single individuals is because there are particular kinds of events that require response that is at you know at the scale of smaller time Windows than is typically capable with um processes that include large numbers of people so that's another attention uh in terms of needing to solve that without uh without falling back into sort of the central executive idea but those are just sort of the cluster of thoughts that come into my mind when that question arises um what the first thing that come up for me is that I would I would profoundly caution that principle of asymmetry that um

I'm reasonably confident that the right way to do this is to almost perfectly invert our current way of doing things and our habits and intuitions meaning um a radical regeneration of actual real relationality and orientation of sovereignty I.E Choice making Authority and power to the lower level more intimate locations is profoundly the right way of doing things and so that most people for the most most of the time most of their choices are actually

being governed by high context Dynamics
um and then on top of that substrate you
then can actually relatively easily
build a construct that allows kind of a
distributed Cincinnatus where when it is
in fact very important to identify
individuals of extremely unique capacity
to deal with very specific problems that
aren't available within even a vaguely
large local environment
you can press them into it but the point
is that they're so deeply connected
80 of the time into a actual lived
context with all the different um how
does this like strong bond High feedback
loop high quality
subtlety that the capture into the
Instagram model thing it doesn't really
have it's obvious that that's a really
bad idea right if you have people who
are living almost entirely in Virtual
lives where there's really nothing real
in their lives that they don't actually
have real friends they don't have real
territory they don't have real
relationships with even like their
parents or their siblings then it's very
difficult for them to notice that the
Instagram influencer thing is terrible
right because they don't really have
something other than that that is
qualitatively distinct but if they're
actually living a truly healthy life
with all kinds of good positive things
happening then you can pop into this
other role notice that you really don't
want to live there do your job and get
the hell back into a a nurturing

environment

um I should mentioned by the way it's not clear to me that we can actually get from here to there air outside of catastrophe right the navigation of that particular path

um at the very least is a serious serious serious job clearly well beyond the capacities of anything that we have right now so it would be kind of a Tropic Cascade of a series of upgraded capacities that get us to the point where we have that capacity and you know that's uh yeah good luck that was also I think we've talked a little bit about this or exchange a little bit about this uh like on Twitter in terms of one of one of those constraints and when you're talking I just kind of wanted to get your your take on this

um

one of those issues with respect to potentially walking that adaptive uh that adaptive Valley right or like trying to balance upon that like adaptive bridge line between our current local Maxima and perhaps some sort of you know foothold on uh on a on a larger Fitness landscape um or higher point on that Fitness landscape

um

is this idea of national capacity in relation to the geopolitical structure of the rest of the world right because like we're operating not in isolation we're operating you know if we if we delegate uh if we delegate responsibility like this transformation

that brings agency
outside of that Central locus of
coherence that is now this this Behemoth
The Leviathan of the state with its um
primary focus let's say or at least it's
ostensible reason for being as the
maintenance of the integrity and the
boundaries of the entity called the
United States or you know whatever the
nation might be at that scale if that
you know as soon as that sort of starts
to falter it's also perceived by other
agents on the landscape as opportunity
um and then interestingly enough is it
possible to maintain that transformative
traversal in light of whatever pressures
are added on top of our already great
list of pressures uh by other
geopolitical actors and I I suspect that
that's at least one possible reason why
you think that you know a transformation
like this will have to be forced out of
sort of a terrific Cascade collapse or
you know cascading collapses
um but yeah I'd be interested to hear
your take on on that
pyramids so by hypothesis
um let's say that the American Empire is
one giant peacock town and so we're
going to lose it but the good news is we
can't we can afford it in fact we better
off without it
um and so yes I think you're right the
the and it's funny it's almost like a
expanding to fill a niche right we found
ourselves in this odd circumstance of
being first a uh one of two superpowers
and then being an actual Global hegemon

for the very first time in human history
and we expanded to fill that Niche
meaning we we sort of depleted all of
our our excess capacity until we sort of
uh I'd say unconsciously and arbitrarily
sort of deployed the global hegemon game
all the way out to the edge right they
were sort of pushing at the absolute
limits of our control capacity uh and by
the way in the context of all these
other things we've been talking about
like local entropy and parasitism et
cetera and all the niches would open up
in that interior and I would simply
propose that we're already past that
point so uh one might argue that any
kind of change of behavior it comes with
cost of having to give up the benefit of
being a global hedge fund and maybe you
don't want to do that that's kind of the
taintor uh pivot point if you're
familiar with that point in the in the
arc

um how I think that dye has been cast
that we're right now in the process of a
forced uh Cascade down from that
position into some new multipolarity and
that can be and I suspect we've probably
gotten the order of like
three to five maybe seven more years for
that to kind of land all the way down
the land very clearly that that's where
we are but I would say we're past the
top of that point so it's a downhill
let's roll from there and much like this
notion of [___] jobs or the the
demoralization cynicism of being stuck
uh we might find ourselves demoralized

by being unrooted from being Global
hedge fund but we might also recognize
that was actually never a thing that
ever that we really really aspired to be
and could have been or should have been
more importantly could have been it was
doomed in from the very beginning and
that we're right now being forcibly
liberated from a highly dysfunctional
location which then if you sort of
shrink the scope back uh down to a much
smaller scope may actually produce a
large enough
um large x of of time and control
capacity to afford US called The
Generation a generation and a half to
re-establish a more generative
governance infrastructure so that's a an
interesting possibility at least it's a
nice story
wow okay we're gonna live a path
associated with that at least it's not
that path
something interesting
okay to ask a few more questions just
feel free to make sure I have to be very
careful with timing because my wife's
gonna be coming back with my
four-year-old and I have a immediate
responsibility so we can we can go but
be mindful I mean literally hit the red
button and be gone
sounds good please depart
um as family demands so just I'll read a
few more questions and then again I'll
just stay after to give a few
Reflections so what is a good example of
a major expanded decontextualization

that we live in that exists in the culture now

expanded I didn't understand that a major expanded decontextualization maybe a broad scale okay

okay maybe that might be like a synthesis of the the two ways that we were talking about this and maybe in terms of

expanded decontextualization and sense of the the

hyper so the the tendency to see the world uh maladaptively

um through a lens that has grown so ah okay so large that we can see nothing else perhaps the code policy

yeah covet policy is a great example of exactly that right we we built a a medical and

um Healthcare what is it called Public Health infrastructure

pulling forward decontextualizing a very large number of aspects of of about embodied embedded humans and effectively with that digits that put a series of knobs in the cybernetic control structure that when a real problem came up that has extreme systemic complexity the way we ended up dealing with it is we started pulling these knobs as opposed to addressing the underlying systemic complexity we were like okay lockdown why lockdown well lockdown may be an optimal strategy if you think that you could shut down the spreading of a virus and are completely ignoring all the other systemic consequences of lockdown for example

it was kind of like a you go to war with
the Army you have philosophy except that
the control board we had was extremely
low resolution and even contraindicated
by our own past advice in many ways but
but it was at hand and so we pulled the
lovers

um even though there were plenty of us
who were saying you know perhaps
treating this as a giant light switch is
uh is not wise

um but isn't always the best play yeah
yeah and I would also just extend that
point into the the fact that beginning
to reflect on that as a society is also
showing us that there are a number of
other uh decontextualization or or sort
of like frame lock issues that we have
that are quite uh that have built
quite up in a lot of inertia around them
especially around the domain of what we
call science or what is now parodied as
the science or uh scientism which is
like the slightly the more serious uh
conversation that's been going on since
the Advent of uh essentially early
post-modern philosophy in the van sort
of phenomenology like who Cyril and who
Cyril's questioning of uh of of sort of
the the paradigmatic uh nature of
science as a

way of seeing the world that can
displace all of our ways of seeing the
world if we're not careful and um
the tendency of that to because it has
provided such a again this is sort of
this this question of um exploration
finding uh capacity and then that

capacity to becoming so powerful that it
it puts people into habitual mode and
that habitual mode becomes a fallback if
other levels of social uh or
psychological or even mythopoetic
coherence break down so you know to the
extent that people lose other frames for
perceiving reality uh perhaps
for for interpreting their
phenomenological meaning which is you
know what the mythical poetic frame has
provided for so long uh to the extent
that breaks down sometimes for good
reason I mean again there's a lot of
corruption in the church and in religion
and there's a lot of I would say decay
in the sort of interpretive frames
presented uh to
um to upcoming Generations I mean I was
one of those people raised Catholic
um initially left the church became
essentially anti-theist for quite some
period of time before beginning to
realize only through evolutionary
education and looking at sort of the
game theoretic lens in terms of deep
history that you know there was
something there there was a there there
and that it wasn't necessarily something
we could jettison but many people have I
think many people were in that same
position and being in that position have
jettisoned in that frame falling back
upon the purely uh scientific frame but
not themselves doing science being
associated with the process therefore
falling into a dogma and being willing
to trust the high priest therefore

creating an incentive for high priests
who are mouthing the words and playing
the game of Politics as opposed to
really committed to the continued
process of discovery and transformation
and representation that we know is
science and uh you know getting
ourselves into that whole situation and
I think we're still a very live
conversation we're still trying to
figure this out and you know what is
What is the relationship between science
can you have a scientific exploration of
mythopolitic concert trucks I think
that's a really fascinating possible
field that also active difference would
have a lot to say in terms of the
emergent structure of collective
Behavior Uh that's sort of the same kind
of questions like really digging into
and beginning to examine the kind of
questions you were talking about earlier
with respect to what it means for
different people to have different
traits Tendencies of perception
personality traits what that ontology
looks like you're saying maybe 7 to 40
uh psychotypes or something like that
what the Dynamics of that as an
emergency system actually look like in
terms of their feedback and
parametrization on the underlying
structure and evolution of our society
and how mythogletic structures and
scientific perspectives change those
perceptions and interaction with one
another in Dynamic feedback mechanisms
with one another or dynamic feedback

relations with one another I mean these are all questions for the next 50 years right I mean yeah very important ones I would say yeah so I I liked it for this we're listening I like the fact that you were actually in describing a decontextualized uh camera the structure but it's describing the structure you also were articulating where a lot of the failure conditions emerge and how we find ourselves um like this systemic shift like you don't notice that you're actually moving from science into politics or moving from science into theology into politics and because you don't even notice there's a thing that could happen it's not a risk that you're even contemplating in your behavior and so you're finding yourself on that on that trajectory maybe the the mother of all like who actually met a point being where we are like nearing the end of something the the short answer is to the question is kind of everything so everywhere you look is a hypertrophied example of extended decontextualization and so the problem is actually being aware of what the opposite might even look like um but maybe the mother of all is education the education system I would say that the um the current education system decontextualizes humans it's a development developing humans so radically as to deprive them of probably something between 70 and 90 percent of

Developmental needs which produces probably a net yield of probably a 99 reduction in total human capacity um and many of the things that that Matthew was just bringing up like the embodied facility not just not just the cognitive scientific awareness of the particular psychotypes and their relationships but actually building actual facility in navigating that properly how you individually navigate the world and how you can be in right relationship with distinct other kinds of humans in collaborative spaces like that's actually really hard and it's not the kind of thing that's easy to learn when you're 50 right it's the proper thing to be learning between the ages of like four and twelve and then deployed effectively in particular kinds of contexts between say 12 and 20 like so

um sorry that's a I'm doing the same thing I'm pointing out the things we don't even notice that we have lost my virtue of becoming hyper hyper focused on a very particular set of optimization characteristics

and also education as I think a very very big example of the of the basic problem

yeah and I think that that form of Education to the extent that we can do that we can also begin to see you know in light of what you're saying with respect to uh it's almost everything at this point a key element of that almost everything is the economic domain in

which this plays out uh
you can consider that sort of like a uh
hypertrophic
exploitation of
um
supernormal stimuli right like what is a
supernormal stimuli like these stimuli
that we have that are essentially we've
discovered as part of this reflective
process of Discovery in the domain of
science we've discovered particular ways
of tapping into evolved
um evolve perception action Loops that
are unbounded in their sensitivity right
like there's no you know it's very hard
to identify upper upper Bound for uh you
know how the extent to which you can
advertise self-undermining uh uh food
products or you know ways of spending
your time if in the moment those produce
some sort of extremely positive or
extremely uh uh some high salience
positive affect uh uh experience like
eating sugar or
um you know getting that dopamine
release from the anticipate anticipation
of acknowledgment of one's perspective
online or you know these types of
economic threads that we have created
are specifically you know the profit
maximization threat I think this is this
is often put on the shoulders of the
word capitalism uh as a pointer to some
sort of hand wavy like there's something
going on here and it's capitalism
um but I think at a deeper level what
we're pointing to here is the fact fact
that

because of this very long lineage of frames that we have chosen and and then in many ways like adapted to live within as a function of past adaptive challenges we now live inside this maximal representation of uh of those ideas

in a way that is no longer sustainable so like profit maximization has a myopic Focus leading to identifying those narrow set of Dimensions that are most in line with that narrow metric over the sort of corporate function and then tapping in that that actually successfully tapping into aspects of all the aspects of human psychology and perception that are unbounded it was a search function and eventually it was going to come to rest on like probing The Human Experience in mind until it found those parts that literally would not uh you gotta go I gotta go guys sorry

indeed Jordan

great talk thank you

in any case yeah that's another that's another um that economic threat is another thread to pull on but that was a great conversation

in this uh in the active over time I just want to run through a few hits yeah that I uh wrote down from this great convo and just plant some seeds for how maybe we can continue 35.2 or in the future

all right so in the very beginning there was a discussion of something like a meta Theory among the three of [__]

with respect to science heck with
respect to business and tainted with
respect to politics and
we can even see that meta Theory as the
prototypical
perception cognition action or eco-evo
Devo Loop so you spoke to the
transformational mapping between
perception and action which is basically
what cognition is we just say it's
everything between
that map between perception and action
and hence active inference as a
prototypical framework for not solving
but framing some of these contexts
then yeah there's a structured way of
mapping those first steps onto available
actions and then and identifying I mean
interestingly enough like one of the
most essential aspects of the framework
is that capacity to switch between the
development or like reduction of
variational free energy in the moment
understanding like whether my
representation of parsing reality in
action what I'm doing is actually in
line with uh the causal structure of my
local environment versus this explore
exploit future oriented frame of
reference in light of um when is it time
to actually uh search out some
disruption or some entropy so that that
entropy injection into my locally uh
ossified frame can open me up again to
uh navigating that adaptive landscape
and introducing new maps between
perception and action that can
facilitate my continued adaptation

awesome so I wanted to actually go to
the free energy with we had the earliest
Epoch of human collaboration
which Jordan characterized as sort of an
unconscious

and that is a lot like type 1 thinking
in the type 1 type 2 system and it's a
lot like variational free energy it's
just this real-time unfolding
ball goes downhill modality
type 2 thinking second stage
civilization as per Jordan and expected
free energy is where we actually have
the double-edged sword of the rollout
and anticipation and we've seen
simulations in octave where a tiny
proportion of hypothesized negative
outcomes even if they're totally
avoidable

Drive rumination and anxiety and high
variance estimates and then the question
is

is there a third Epoch is there a third
mode that uses attention to modulate the
balance or the Reliance between the
variational and the expected free energy
and to what extent is that attentional
modulation

implicit tacit on board not automatable
and to what extent could that kind of
wisdom be reflected in our externalized
niche

and that connects to the question of
Automation and transparency around our
information architecture Communications
and our infrastructure
and

I I thought of first a sort of

infrastructural incompleteness or
instability theorem like even if you get
all of layer one automated then of
course Layer Two has not been automated
so there's always the hyper prior
and um also that Min to opponent
processing thinking with tensegrity
architecture compression and tension
could we have systems where instead of
just trying to oh we want this object
hanging here we'll just put a pillar
underneath it and then we'll put a pill
underneath that like are we going to
compress all the way down or could we
have a harmonic mode that involved
compression and tension and that's how
it stayed flying
then just yeah last oh go ahead and then
I have two last points
I I'd go either way but yeah I mean
there's there's a lot of resonance here
with some of the things I'm working on
literally right now in terms of uh
attempting to uh attempting to
work with active inference as a like I
was saying earlier as a uh that
cognitive mapping like that that mapping
you can look at it also as a category
theoretic mapping
um within a category and a set of
morphisms right between this sort of uh
space of perception and the space of
action and you can then also
in that sense integrate that into a
larger
hypothesis around the topology of
emergence and then develop that as a
toolkit which is interesting because

inactive inference through the lens of
active inference in theory everything
can be active inference and then it
leads to this sort of recursive
hierarchical structure but
following thinkers such as like Robert
Rosen in terms of his and like uh
vashevsky and relational biology and
bringing in theories of a temporal
causal structure
that basically can contextualize the
temporal unfolding of entailments you
can actually use those understandings to
you to to take active inference as a as
a tool and weave it into larger Fabrics
like you're talking about and and those
fabric connections they are related to
active inference but they're not
necessarily
active inference itself although you
could then take a meta step outside of
that and say we can apply the principles
to the entire system but but there's
this role of understanding novel
closures of observing of reflexivity and
that reflexivity I think is a really
like the person I describe is the
approach I'm taking to introduce a a
different kind of reflexivity and a kind
that I believe is consonant with
multi-scale arbitrarily complex
emergence into the to the world of
active inference but you know
experimenting with how to stitch active
inference together into itself I think
is a very uh you know the entire field
is new and exploratory but even amongst
that it's a is that the sort of

periphery in the edge of exploration

um so

indeed and just these last two points uh

Brie collage was mentioned and active

inference helps us with the

composability legibility and simulation

emulation analytics on different systems

physical cyber physical cognitive

unknown

Etc so if we're doing brick collage on

the edges now we have the glue or the

sticky tape or whatever it is and then

last point was on the peacocks and

pyramids

it's not so simple as just an Adaptive

buffer even throwing a pleiotropy so the

consequences on different phenotypes uh

aside because it becomes integrated as

the kind of thing I am

and so yes it's like the Eraser is the

capacity of the pencil but we don't rub

our erasers all the way down we're not

always on our last life in the video

game and a symbol that on one hand the

energy could have been diverted to some

other purpose that symbol can actually

become

um

an introduction at even the mythopoetic

level

and therefore actually

lose its capacity to be an Adaptive

buffer at one level

and become a pivotal player

at another level the buffer I think that

is that's also like related to that

Instagram problem right where it's like

and it's particularly with respect to

the abstraction of that buffer as well
right so like if you abstract the buffer
as wealth the buffer is inferior signal
of underlying quality of behavior to
accumulating
resources uh over and above the
requisite level of short-term
consumption or metabolic need right
that's the evolutionary instinct we have
for sort of appreciating someone who has
quote unquote gathered well at least by
means that were constructive or
generative
um but then you can you know to the
extent that becomes associated with
identity right and then you look at the
signals as that wealth manifests in a
particular culture as the proxy
measurement for the underlying for the
underlying phenomenon then you can start
to get into the manipulation of those
signals if someone understands and
observes others behaving as if the
signals were the process of production
of that capacity for well that the
capacity production of generating wealth
or useful byproducts then you can see
again this immersion parasitism uh
element dropping in there because people
will try to middleman that process and
say if I can get you to treat me as
if I am that person maybe I can get
access to whatever Associated uh
privileges come alongside that so so
yeah 100 that's a um
that identity Association and and all of
the games that it opens up are is
essentially Central what's your main to

what we're talking about what we were
talking about

awesome and uh a closing thought
the discussion made me think of a July
4th fireworks for information what does
it look like when the

Weaponry is turned into livingry and
when there can be a symbolic ritual
around the utilization of
that dual functional technology
within the boundaries
across those levels

yeah I mean we're in a beautiful time
for that right now I think so much of
the emerging technology the generative
Technologies out there especially under
the auspices of AI or ml

um
the capacity to use that generative
toolkit and it's its ability to allow
people to uh a much broader swath of
people to produce potentially resonant
artistic and cultural artifacts that are
Pointers to something they find unique
or interesting or insightful that might
then spread if it aligns with a given
moment or need and that's particularly
fascinating to me as a
as a catalyst for increasing our
capacity to think collectively uh you
know transcending just the verbal domain
and bringing in other sensory modalities
uh aligned with the word I mean that's
the funny thing about these llms right
like they're large language models and
you know language can act as that fabric
as that as that
um

you know language as the net neural network itself as the as the computational network between these other sensory apparatus and and the ability to to produce artifacts that bring people into forms of alignment or phenomenological resonance that just would not have otherwise existed um now you know people are there are potential downsides this as well just like anything but you know I'm very excited about that because I look at you know the all of the art that I've seen uh this new generative artwork it is like you know very much informational fireworks right people are able to take five ideas they heard today you could go you know based on this podcast you could basically say like take any subsection of that produce a series of generative artworks and then associate that lineage or like that like series of generative art with this as a network a visual Network that could be a dynamic placeholder you know that could attract attention uh automatically from the potential Network that resonates with that artwork right and and and tap into the latent space of this conversation that none of us hold explicitly in our heads but we're all pointing to it based on our words and our conversations and the kind of things we're trying to talk about here like there is a latent space representation uh possible so yeah I mean I think we're in fascinating times for that and using that as a tool constructively and wisely and I'm

looking forward to seeing seeing that
part of this unfold
thank you Matthew thank you to Jordan
till next time
yeah I think so always a pleasure